

THE EVOLUTIONARY PROCESS

Greetings, my very dearest friends. Blessings for all of you here. Happiness and love follow truth -- the commitment to truth, whatever it may be. Deep in your heart is the seed for all these potentials: truth, love, happiness, wisdom, and peace. You possess these attributes, these states of being in ample quantity and quality. It is up to you to realize them, which you do by first conceiving of these potentialities deep inside of your innermost being. You then conceive of spreading out these slumbering potentials, to awaken and spread them outward so that they grow from within into the outer regions of your life.

The topic of tonight's lecture is the process of the evolutionary journey, for it is a journey. This process begins to be noticed increasingly as you grow through your efforts on your path. The process is something you see increasingly as an organic reality that communicates itself to you. It has its own laws, its own sequences, its own rhythm, its own extreme wisdom, and its own inner meaning. At the beginning of your path, you sense it only vaguely and only occasionally, but as you progress, as you become more anchored in truth inside of you, you see this process unfolding as an extremely organic happening, as an alive, organismic event.

The mistake you make is in believing that this organismic event, this process is a result of your decision to follow such a path, a path in which you find yourself and develop. But that is a misconception. The process exists always. The only difference is that when you are not on a path that activates awareness of your inner reality, when you are still in blindness and ignorance about yourself and therefore commensurately about the universe, you must also be totally blind to this process going on in you. So, first of all, it is extremely important that you understand that difference, my friends. The process is not something that happens only after you enter on a developmental path. But the entering and progressing on such a path enables you to focus your awareness on something that has always existed but that you have not noticed and that, above all, that you will be able to follow, go along with, in which you can involve the ego personality rather than let it stay behind.

This is another aspect of awakening consciousness, and in that sense this lecture is also a sequence of the preceding one. Consciousness is not something that happens suddenly. It is rather a process of awakening to something that has always been there. Awakening consciousness suddenly perceives psychic events, inner events as well as outer events, states of being in the self and in others, connections and interrelationships between people and things, between individual and cosmic consciousness. Why has it always been there? Because time is but the illusion of the limited mind. And the limitation of that mind is also responsible for not perceiving what is there. As the mind becomes less limited, it becomes capable of perceiving what is there. It will make all the difference for you, my friends, not to confuse this with the "sequence of events," for this new perception will activate an aspect of your consciousness that is still slumbering: your power to

perceive in reality. In the slumbering state, man always confuses cause and effect, he always looks through the wrong end of the telescope and thus becomes more confused.

Now, you may begin to conceive of the process of your inner journey, of your evolutionary journey as being always present, as being ongoing whether you know it or not. Let us now speak more specifically about this process so that you will obtain further help in self-understanding, so that you can begin to focus in the right direction. I might compare this evolutionary process that exists within all aspects of consciousness, all entities, and all organismic realities as a journey -- an ongoing journey.

Man often has dreams in which he is either on a train ride or he is about to take a train and anxious that he may miss it or he has missed the train or he is trying not to miss the train or maybe he is getting off a train. These are recurrent dreams in almost all human beings. They are universal dreams that come in sporadic periods. When they come, they convey your relationship to your own process. Do you follow its movement? Or do you stay behind? The process goes on as the train continues its ride, but the ego consciousness has a choice. It can choose to go with it, or it can choose to stay behind. These choices are not always consciously made, but they are nevertheless made in distinct intentionality. (I just wish to note parenthetically that when you do not happen to have a train dream, this is not an indication or proof that you are following the inner journey. The unconscious may not always succeed in sending its message to the consciousness, or the messages may be given in a different form.)

For example, when an individual chooses to enter such a path, chooses to search within himself, chooses to make more meaning out of his life, that is as much of a choice as when he chooses not to do so, regardless of the rationales and excuses he may manufacture for himself. When he lives into the day as if it did not matter, that is as active and distinct a choice as when he allows himself to feel the inner urging to follow his inner journey. When he is passive and inert, it is as much of a choice as when he is active and takes the initiative. These are all choices. Do you go with your inner, evolutionary process, or do you stay behind?

The choice is determined by how much you give in to the always existing fear and resistance that is so tragically misplaced. Because if anything needs to be feared and resisted, it is the nonmovement, the stagnation, the denial of going with the process that evolves out of your innermost being as the wisest, most meaningful reality conceivable. Therefore, my friends, when you resist following the inner movement that is so much wiser, so much more profound than what the human brain can think of, you make a decision, a weighty decision. And it is important for you to understand what that decision means. What does it imply? And, also, what are its ramifications?

I want to say here that the decision in question is not just whether or not to enter such a path as this. Even if the general decision for such a path has been made and is being followed, even if the general commitment has been made, there may nevertheless be areas where a reserve is kept. "I will only go so far and no further. Here I will not go along with the inner train of my movement. Here or there I will hold on and stay behind and not give up or change. I will go that far and then I will get off the train even while I still follow the pathwork in other areas." You see, my friends, in psychic reality it is possible to be on the train in some respects, but off the train in others. These others count heavily because they create an imbalance and discrepancy. Have you gotten off your train in some areas, my friends, and perhaps dwell in an interim station and then try to get on again?

But do you not realize that the train does not wait? Your inner movement follows its innate plan and when the ego gets off, the inner movement still goes on. It is then so much more difficult to catch up again. When you are in such a predicament, you experience long, drawn-out states of disharmony, anxiety, crisis, depression, upheaval.

It is of course realistically quite impossible for man to always follow the inner movement exactly 100 percent. Were he that aware, he would not be in the human state. The human state is in itself the result of disconnection, and thus struggle is required to find the connection again with the inner reality. So no human being, no path-follower can ever boast of never going through periods of darkness and crisis. That is inevitable, and it is good that way because these very states are reminders, messages, and signposts to spur man to make concerted efforts toward finding again the harmony with the inner meaning of the individual process. But I am speaking here of protracted states of disharmony, of escape, of resistance on a larger scale to deal with certain areas of the self. The question can be simply stated as follows: Are you totally committed to all of yourself, to the whole truth, to complete nonavoidance, and to real surrender to the will of God? Only you can give a truthful answer to this question. You can easily know the answer if you wish to know. You can easily determine if and how you hold out, what are the areas where you hold back and make reservations, and where you deny the holy process of your inner movement into divine reality.

Some form of a battle is always required to make you understand the signs, the messages, the directions of your inner process so as to get into its swing again. Each stopping is much more of a delay than you realize. When I speak of delay, I do not want to give the impression that you should be hasty and rushed in your mental attitude, but rather that you should realize and perhaps learn to tune in on the movement of your process and learn to understand its messages and its meaning, as well as learn to understand the meaning of your fear and resistance that make you stay behind and get off the train, as it were.

If you truly examine this fear and resistance as to its most simple core and translate the meaning of this fear and resistance, what will inevitably evolve is something like this: "I do not trust divine reality. I do not trust divine life. I do not trust my higher self. I do not trust God's creation and God's will for and in me. I would rather trust my ego-defenses and protective blockings, no matter how destructive they may happen to be. I may regret this destructiveness, but since I trust it more than God, I will continue with it." Thus, you would rather trust the pseudo-reality of your misconceptions, of your puny fears and defenses, of false safety, of illusions of the laziness and the lure of the line of least resistance. You particularly trust the illusion that it is not necessary to move along with your evolutionary process. Thus you deny yourself the awareness that it even exists. You distrust the beauty of the inner movement, and you trust the stagnation of stopping it. You distrust the truth and trust the denial of truth. You trust in closing your sensibilities to the messages of your process. You never even give yourself the chance to find out how much God, the process, truth, and total commitment to confronting all that is in you and thus following your process can be trusted; while you despair about your constant disappointments, refusing to connect them with the fact that you consistently trust the wrong things. You choose to trust wishful thinking, you trust the motto that what you do not know does not exist and will not hurt you. You deny that you miss out on fulfilling the potential within you. Thus you create more illusion, more false reality, and become more disconnected, confused, empty -- choosing not to understand why and accusing life of being bad. All the time you fear and resist the truth and beauty, the benign reality you could live in. All

this may not apply to all of you, but even if it applies only to part of you, to some aspects, it represents waste, unnecessary struggle.

Consider all this, my friends. Ponder the question of misplaced trust and misplaced distrust that makes you decide to get off the train and to let it go by and stay behind -- be it only temporarily but nevertheless stay behind. So it is very important, my friends, that you render an account to yourself about your decisions, and that you trust and confront these issues -- even if you manage not to know that you are making decisions every day and every hour of your life. These are decisions about what to think, about how to view events in your life and your reactions to them, about where to direct your attention in your daily life -- to the outer projections of your inner realities or to the inner realities themselves. All these are decisions that you constantly make. If you test yourself as to the meaning of these decisions -- and that they are indeed decisions -- at least you will stop the creation of an illusory and false reality that gives so much pain and fear. "Illusory reality" may sound like a contradiction, but it is not, for temporary, illusory realities are constantly being manufactured and believed in. Life on earth is the best example of it.

It is therefore so very essential that you question yourself in deep concern about where you are in regard and in relationship to your own process and to what it means. Then, when you have answered yourself, the next question should be, what is the meaning of this answer? Are you really allowing yourself to be guided by that inner movement, and do you overcome the line of least resistance to follow that movement? It is only at the beginning of each such decision that to make it seems such an effort. But that effort in itself is one of the illusions you created by constant belief in falsity (in this case that non-movement is effortless and movement is struggle). In reality, the effort lies in staying behind and stemming against the movement, while effortlessness, ease, and inner relaxation lie in the harmony that is being established between the ego and the inner process of movement through the decision to follow the same speed, to discover the meaning of your process.

And that brings me to the next aspect of this topic, which is that there is no event in your life, big or small, outer or inner, that is not an intrinsic message or meaningful manifestation of the whole process. Your task and path consists really of deciphering these "messages," of understanding the meaning behind the events or moods you are in. To the degree you make deliberate efforts to do so, you will succeed, not immediately and not always in a straight line. But the meaning will evolve, surely and inexorably. And the more this is the case, the deeper your security, peace, and joy will be. Conversely, the meaning of your life and your experiences, your moods and states of mind will never take on deeper meaning without concerted effort and commitment. To the degree you don't make this effort and commitment, your life will be sterile and anxiety-ridden.

When you experience events as isolated haphazard happenings, life must appear meaningless, frightening, confusing, and burdensome. When you begin to perceive the incredible meaning and meaningfulness, the much wider wisdom and purpose of every event -- how it is deeply connected with and a part of the wise and wholesome totality of your life, of the sequences of life -- then all fear and confusion must vanish because everything you experience has its deepest meaning and connection. That awareness can be established only when your outer consciousness is willing to make the effort and is willing to overcome the always existing temptation to yield in the direction of least resistance. Usually you just put it aside -- this event or that mood or this happening or that inner climate or a particular state of emotional reaction -- as one of those things that happen because of an isolated, disconnected coincidence. Even though you may no longer pay lip service to

coincidence, your emotional reactions are still geared to them as if your experience were a product of "them." "If only this or that would have happened differently, then I would be happy." Or, "If only this particular person could react differently, then all would be well." These familiar reactions, although not necessarily expressed in these exact words, indicate a still lingering belief that life happens haphazardly and that your state of mind depends on others and circumstances that have little if anything to do with a meaningful reality beyond the surface. This is why you become depressed, anxious, confused. It is only when you ask yourself about whatever happens to you every day and every hour of your life, "How could this be a message or a reflection or an indication or a sign of a total picture about my life and its course that I still do not completely grasp?" that you will gain meaningful answers, that the inner cohesive reality will reveal itself to you. Then all the little pieces of your life, of your experiences, of your state of mind will fall into place. Believe me, my friends, there is nothing you experience that does not have to be exactly the way it is and not because some deity predestines it for you in a spirit of punishment or reward. That kind of thinking totally misses the point. Rather, it is more like this: your experiences are the product of where you are on your journey within your own process. This is why you cannot be at any other place.

Let us assume an organism, human or any other, is very angry, very self-rejecting, very impatient because its own growth process is only halfway accomplished. Let us assume a child is angry and impatient, guilty and self-rejecting because it is not yet an adult. Would that not be foolish? The growth process is in itself beautiful, meaningful, and to be respected. It is the same with the evolutionary process that includes the purification of distortions and negativity. If an organism is only half grown, that is exactly where that organism is and to scold it (or its own consciousness scolding itself for it) is senseless. Only when that state is fully accepted and not obstructed, when its meaning with its ramifications is clear (which includes a clear assessment of the effect of negativity), then the growth process is free to evolve. Rejection of the current state and anger about it are obstructions that are like barricades prohibiting the "train" to take its course. If you apply this principle to the physical level, it is easy to see. Imagine that you squeeze a growing physical organism into a tight container. This would thwart the growth and cripple the organism. It is the same with mental and psychic processes. Misunderstanding the dynamics of growth, the necessity of growth, the meaning of it; with its process of purification, consciousness-expansion, and deepening of perception and thus feeling impatient about the present state; only leads to self-hate, denial, repression, self-justification, and projecting onto others and therefore to more negativity, real guilt, greater confusion, in short, to crippling of the growing organism.

Off hand it may appear as if this attitude of impatience with the limited state of the self indicated eagerness to grow and the good will toward a more perfected state and consciousness. These attributes are, of course, the original divine qualifications behind the distorted expression -- and this is good to know. But it is just as important to know that the way this manifests is in distortion and is far from furthering the growth process.

You can see where you are once you free yourself of the additional and unnecessary burden and negativity of the denial of your present state. Denial and repression lead to self-justification, destructive guilt, and blaming of others. These are unnecessary and additional burdens your pathwork helps you to shed. Then you can perceive your present state for which you have entered the process of evolution, for which you have contracted an incarnatory chain. You thus are part of the divine plan to bring light into the void. Wherever your manifest consciousness has "forgotten"

its connection and lost touch with its divine nature, there lies your task which is destined to reestablish this connection.

Ignorance of these principles and truths leads to hating the incomplete present state, which in turn results in hate of self, therefore fear of self, therefore resistance to the whole of your being -- to let it out, view it impartially, assess it objectively, and infuse it with truth. You can see the logical sequence of psychic events here in clear demonstration. When you no longer fear and hate yourself, you will not fear and resist the journey. You will go with it. When you have nothing to fear in you, you have nothing to fear of the journey of life, of change -- to the contrary. You will look for the different landscapes with joy and excitement, in complete trust. You must understand, my friends, the inexorable connection between fear of self and fear of life as opposed to total commitment to all of the self, hence increasing loss of fear of self, hence trust in self, hence trust in life. Making the total commitment to yourself means making the total commitment to following harmoniously the movement of your process. Hating and rejecting your present state means fearing yourself, which means obstructing your journey and movement. This means "missing your train."

Each process is intrinsically your own, each process is intrinsically different from the next one. Each individual has his own reality even though that reality must be in concordance with the universal reality based on its laws and truths. The acceptance of the state you are in leads to going with your movement, with your process, and to fearlessly allowing to let out what there may be! So I say to you, my friends, let these words be an incentive and inspiration to you to make a fuller and more total commitment to all of yourself. For in that way you will find the trust in your inner process and will understand its truly heavenly beauty! You will understand its language that will communicate itself to you and through which you will discover the immeasurable beauty of that process, the wisdom of it, the meaning of it, and the peace that is contained in it. You will feel the ever ongoing aliveness that you know you possess and are a part of, regardless of the outer manifestations. These outer manifestations are, as I said, in themselves a meaningful and alive part of the whole even though they may momentarily seem painful, ugly, and not alive. But when the connection between these manifestations and your process are being made, the perception must change drastically. And what was experienced as senseless, therefore frightening and ugly, becomes suddenly infused with divine meaning.

There are a number of laws that apply to the evolutionary inner process. These laws must not be confused with the general universal laws which apply to all states of consciousness and to all entities. They apply to those beyond the evolutionary process, to those not yet within the evolutionary process, as well as to those who are within it. But then there are the laws of the process itself that apply only to those who have entered into this process. Some of these laws you will learn in the course of our future lectures. Now, I would like to speak about two important such laws which will be very useful for you to work with.

The first is that the further the inner consciousness is advanced in that process -- or to put it differently, the greater the spiritual potentiality to go with the process, to be aware of it, and to understand it and its meaning -- the greater must be the repercussion if that potentiality is not followed through. If an individual is, for example, ready to follow such a demanding path of self-confrontation and growth but resists his experiences and states of mind, he will lack peace, joy, meaning, and aliveness, which is not true about an individual who is simply not yet at the point where such a path can be followed. When I speak of repercussions, I do not necessarily mean

tragedy, although that, too, is part of it. The greater the discrepancy between a person's spiritual potentiality and the actual direction he takes in life, the more severe his experiences are. But often it is not just a tragic event that indicates such a discrepancy. It may even be more often a chronic state of depression, anxiety, and, truly, disconnectedness! The same principle applies to those who are already on such a path. They may, on the whole, be committed to it but keep a part of themselves in reserve. They do not commit all of themselves to the process. They hold back in fear, shame, secrecy, and in the wishful thinking that this will not matter. The thus resulting inevitable blindness, be it only a momentary one, must present experiences that are puzzling, painful, disquieting, confusing, or simply robbing you of your momentary peace.

When you learn to view your daily, even your hourly, life in terms of what does the mood you are in, the experience you have, the perceptions you have reveal in regard to your process; then you will go with the process, and you will also recognize that the disturbance is also a reflection of some blindness. Often that blindness lies in a totally different direction from the one you half-consciously fear and assume. The moment you know that, you have the freedom and the possibility to use this knowledge as your gauge, as your doorway, as your key. Do you have to allow the discrepancy between your process and your ego state to accumulate into more disturbing elements so that the repercussions become more unpleasant? This is not a punishment, my friends. It is the grace of God that has made it so in order to help you to not stay behind in a useless stagnation, to give you the incentive, if you only choose to open your eyes, to use these experiences and pray deeply for the guidance to understand and let yourself be open to the guidance and trust yourself to the will of God and go with it. Let yourself be carried with it. Make, on the one hand, all the effort possible to see, to comprehend, to search deeply for the meaning, to overcome resistance. On the other hand, surrender yourself to the inner movement that will carry you. These are not two contradictory premises. They are mutually interdependent attitudes. Make the effort to overcome with the ego attributes; but also give up the ego control to the guidance of the divine inner will and movement. In this way your potentiality, if it were always kept up, would create a faultlessly peaceful and happy life. Since you are in the human shell of blindness and since you have to battle against the aspects in yourself which are as yet unrealized and undeveloped, you have to use this very blockage of your potential as an incentive that will give you the opportunity to avoid staying behind and avoid the repercussions to a considerable degree. The degree is really all that matters, for some blindness, as I said, is quite inevitable.

The more your path progresses, the more aware you become of this inner meaning of the process. You can take the tiniest mood of disturbance and ask yourself: "What does it mean in terms of my inner process? Where am I blind? What may I see differently?"

The second law I wish to speak about is making connections. When connections are being made, the process evolves in its full glory. When connections are not being made, the process remains hidden and events take on an isolated and disquieting appearance. Now, there are connections to be made, primarily between your outer experiences and the inner process on the one hand and between inner attitudes that seem totally disconnected from one another on the other hand. Let me briefly speak about both.

The first -- connections between the outer life, your inner moods, reactions, and the process -- can be made only in the way I said before: that you first of all consider the possibility of such a connection, open yourself up to its realization. The moment you raise that question and open up to

receiving the meaning, the meaning will communicate itself to you sooner or later. As these meanings become clear, as you begin to see all experiences as intrinsically meaningful events in terms of your total inner reality and in terms of your total path as well as every particle thereof, you will gain a totally new and infinitely more connected understanding of life.

The second category, making connections between inner aspects -- problematic aspects, for example -- is something you begin to experience as you progress on your path. But much more of that can and will happen. You discover, in the course of your path, apparently isolated problems (outer as well as inner), faults, shortcomings, impurities, conflicts, difficulties whose inner dynamics you as yet ignore -- and they seem to have nothing to do with one another. And yet, as you go deeper, there is a direct connection between these apparently disconnected attitudes and aspects. For example, what connection could there be between a difficulty in establishing fulfilling relationships and a blockage in your career? Or what connection could there exist between a greedy and pushy attitude and, say, sexual dissatisfaction? Or between submissiveness, lack of self-assertion, on the one hand, and covert hostility on the other? I could name many more such examples. To see the connection between them will give you a new sense of meaning and wholeness and understanding. Suddenly things are no longer so fragmented and anxiety-producing. You may first only sense the totality in all these various connections, but little by little it is more than just a sensing. It is a real and strong understanding in depth. The parts of the whole are all put together. There is nothing in you that does not connect with everything else whether it be good, bad, or indifferent, whether it be positive or negative. Not only are various positive aspects connected with one another that seem different in kind from one another, not only are different negative aspects connected with one another, but so are positive and negative aspects directly linked on an inner level.

To establish these connections you can and should use your mental abilities to whatever degree you can, almost in a spirit of exercising your mind. To some degree that may be helpful. But primarily it must come from within. You must allow the intuitive faculties to provide you with the connection. And then everything will take on a new form, a new shape.

These two laws are very important for you to understand. I hope that this lecture will contribute to your deliberate choice of finding out what your outer life means in terms of your inner process in order to make the renewed and daily choice and commitment to trust the movement of that process and follow it and not stay behind. The more you do this, the more exhilarated your consciousness and energetic system will become, the more joyful and peaceful and secure and meaningful your life will be -- meaningful in terms of the total creative process, not just of this one individual life span. You will know and sense deeply that you are a part of a much larger process of which this one little life span is only a small link in a very large chain.

As I leave you and give you blessings and love, I want to say to all of you that there is so much growth, so much change happening in so many, many of my friends. There is so much sincere devotion to your path and so many real fruits that you begin to reap. That is a beautiful sight for us in spirit. We see the form of it, we see the light of it, we see the glory of it. And we know the value of it, how you contribute to all of life with each little, individual step of progress you make. You are blessed, all of you, my dearest, dearest friends. Be in peace.

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